

PERCEPTION AND PERSONALITY



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AGENDA

- Concept
- Perceptual Process.
- Attribution Theory.
- Errors and Biases in Attributions
- Perception and Decision Making.
- Personality traits and Characteristics.
 - Personality and Behavior
- Major Personality attributes influencing Organizational Behavior.

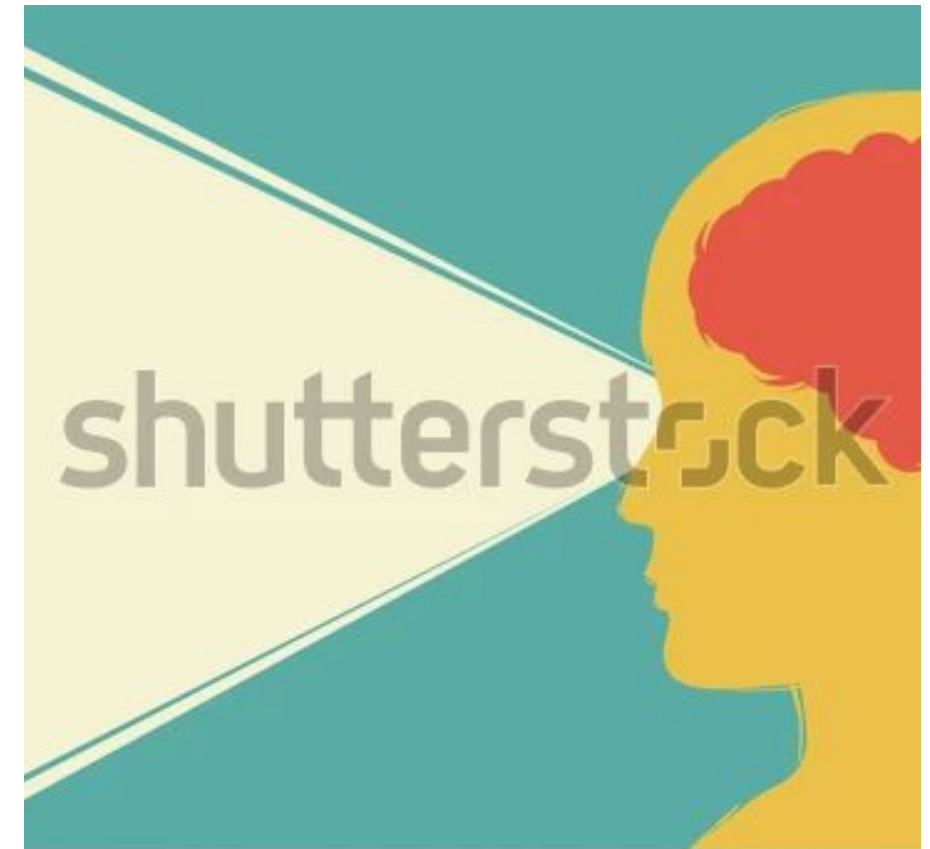
WE DON'T SEE THINGS AS THEY ARE,
WE SEE THINGS AS WE ARE.



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People are unique. Their behavior is based on the perception of what reality is, not on reality itself. Perception is an important determinant of individual behavior. It provides an individual view of reality. It is a cognitive factor of human behavior.

Perception is a very complex process that yields a unique picture of the world, a picture that may be quite different from reality.



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Definition

Stephen P. Robbins

A process by which individuals organize and interpret their sensory impressions in order to give meaning to their environment.

Newstrom and Davis

Perception is an individual's own view of the world. It is the unique way in which each person sees, organizes and interprets things. It gives meaning to information.

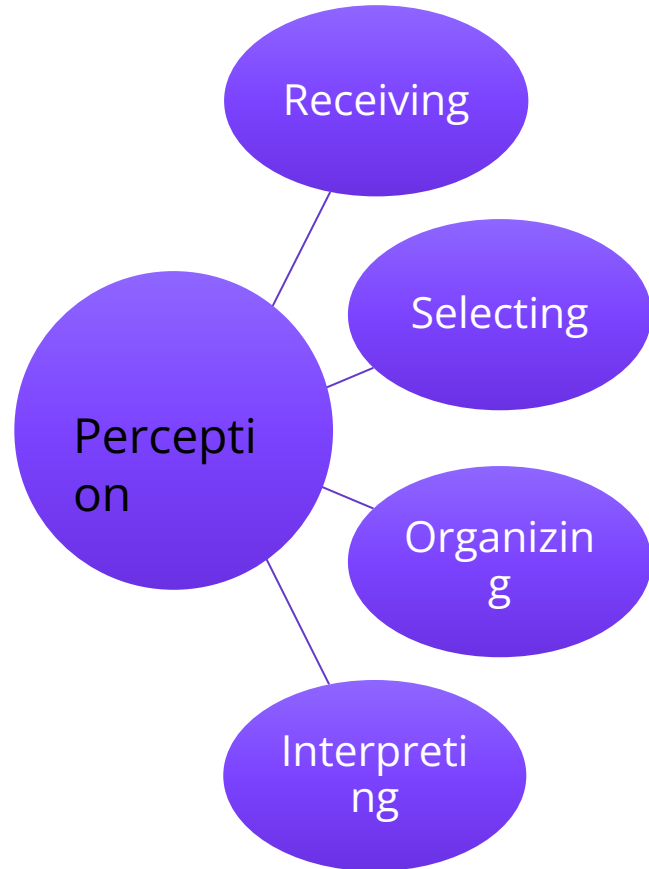
Feed Luthans

The perception process can be defined as a complicated interactions of selection, organization and interpretation.



The Perceptual Process

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The Perceptual Process

Receiving

Receiving is the first and most important stage in the process of perception. It is the initial stage in which a person collects all information and receives the information through the sense organs.

Selecting

Selecting is the second stage in the process. Here a person doesn't receive the data randomly but selectively. A person selects some information out of all in accordance with his interest or needs. The selection of data is dominated by various external and internal factors.

External factors – The factors that influence the perception of an individual externally are intensity, size, contrast etc.

Internal factors – The factors that influence the perception of an individual internally are psychological requirements, learning, background, experience, self-acceptance, and interest.



Organizing

Keeping things in order or say in a synchronized way is organizing. In order to make sense of the data received, it is important to organize them.

Interpreting

Finally, we have the process of interpreting which means forming an idea about a particular object depending upon the need or interest. Interpretation means that the information we have sensed and organized, is finally given a meaning by turning it into something that can be categorized. It includes stereotyping, halo effect etc.

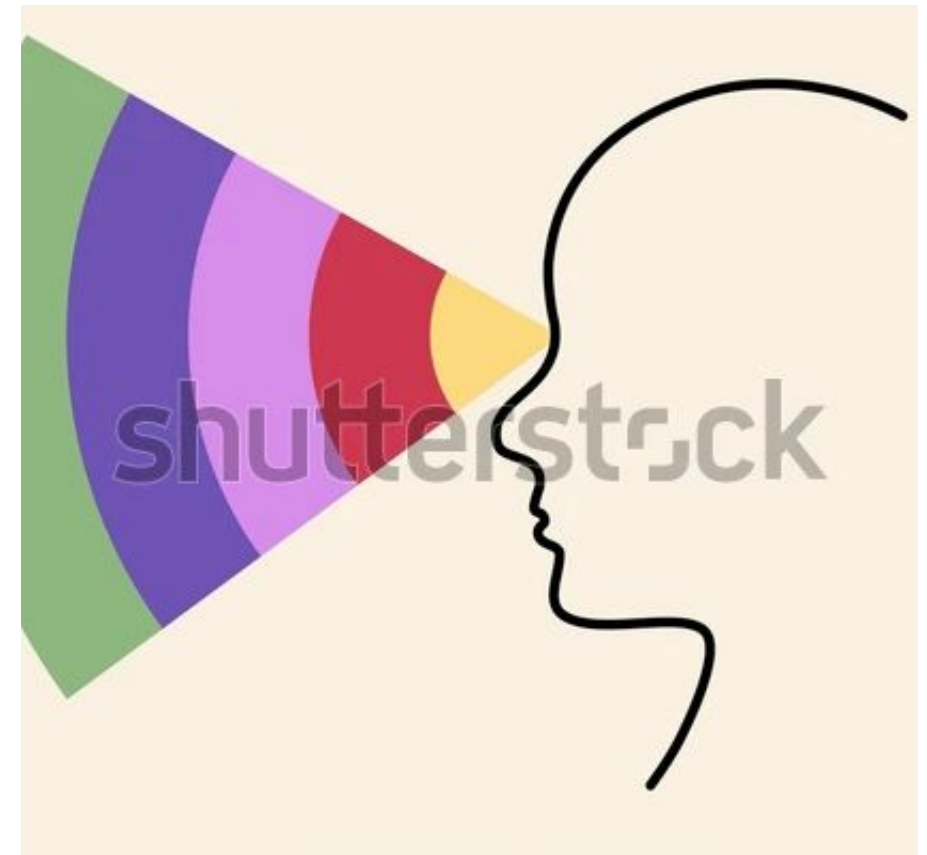


Importance of Perception in OB

We need to understand what the role of perception in an organization is. It is very important in establishing different role of perceptions like –

- Understanding the tasks to be performed.
- Understanding associated importance of tasks allotted.
- Understanding preferred behavior to complete respective tasks.
- Clarifying role perceptions.

For example, every member in a group has to be clear regarding the role allotted to them. Programmer writes the code, tester checks it, etc.



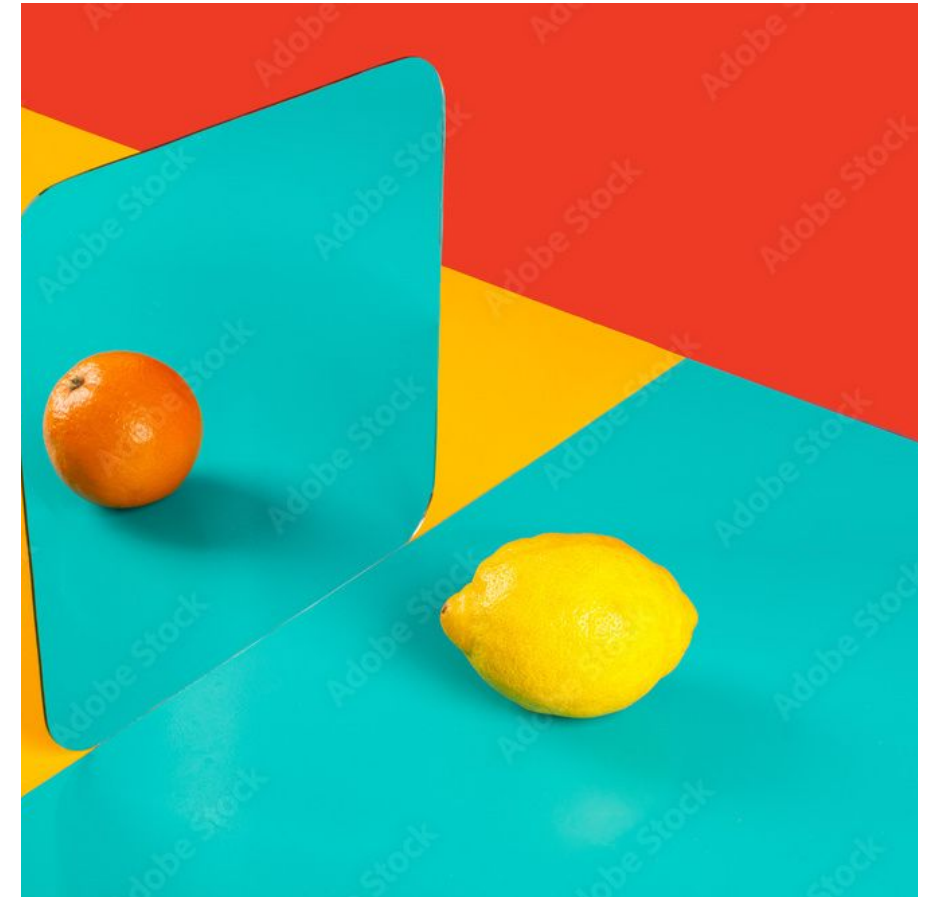
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Attribution Theory

Attribution theory, proposed by Fritz Heider (1958), is a social psychology theory that deals with how individuals relate and make sense of the social world. More specifically, it is concerned with how people translate events around them and how their translations affect their thinking and behavior.

The Attribution Theory seeks to explain why people behave the way they do.

The theory suggest that the behavior of others can be examined on the basis of its distinctiveness, consistency and consensus.



Internal and External Attribution

Heider says that all behavior is considered to be determined by either internal or by external factors:

External Attribution (Situational Attribution): Causality is assigned to an outside factor, agent or force. Outside factors fall outside your control. You perceive you have no choice. So your behavior is influenced, limited or even completely determined by influences outside your control. Therefore you feel not responsible. A generic example is the weather, a difficult customer etc.

Internal Attribution (Dispositional Attribution): Causality is assigned to an inside factor, agent or force. Inside factors fall inside your own control. You can choose to behave in a particular way or not. So your behavior is not influenced, limited or even completely determined by influences outside your control. Therefore you feel responsible. A typical example is your own intelligence.



What are Attribution Factors?



Attribution factors by *Kelley* (1967): Kelley advanced Heider's theory by adding hypotheses about factors that affect the formation of attributions:

- **Consistency information.** The degree to which the actor performs that same behavior toward an object on different occasions.
- **Distinctiveness information.** The degree to which the actor performs different behaviors with different objects.
- **Consensus information.** The degree to which other actors perform the same behavior with the same object.

E.g.

Karan, a manager, has assigned a team of employees to develop a customer sales training program for a client

As the project progresses, Karan continues to see problems in the work produced by Hari, one of the team member. In order to determine why Hari's performance is not satisfactory,

Karan first considers consistency, or whether Hari has performed poorly on other similar projects

A review of his past performance appraisals indicates that he has not had prior performance problems when creating sales training programs. This would lead Karan to conclude that there was an external cause of the poor performance

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Second, Karan considers distinctiveness, he wants to know if Hari has performed poorly on different types of tasks.

Again, in checking Hari's performance reviews, he finds that when he is on a team to accomplish a different type of task, such as developing a selection interview, he has excelled.

This further points to an external cause of Hari's poor performance.



Finally, Karan assesses consensus, or the behavior of others in this similar task

In asking the team members about their experiences with the current project, he finds that many of them have had difficulty in developing this customer sales training program.

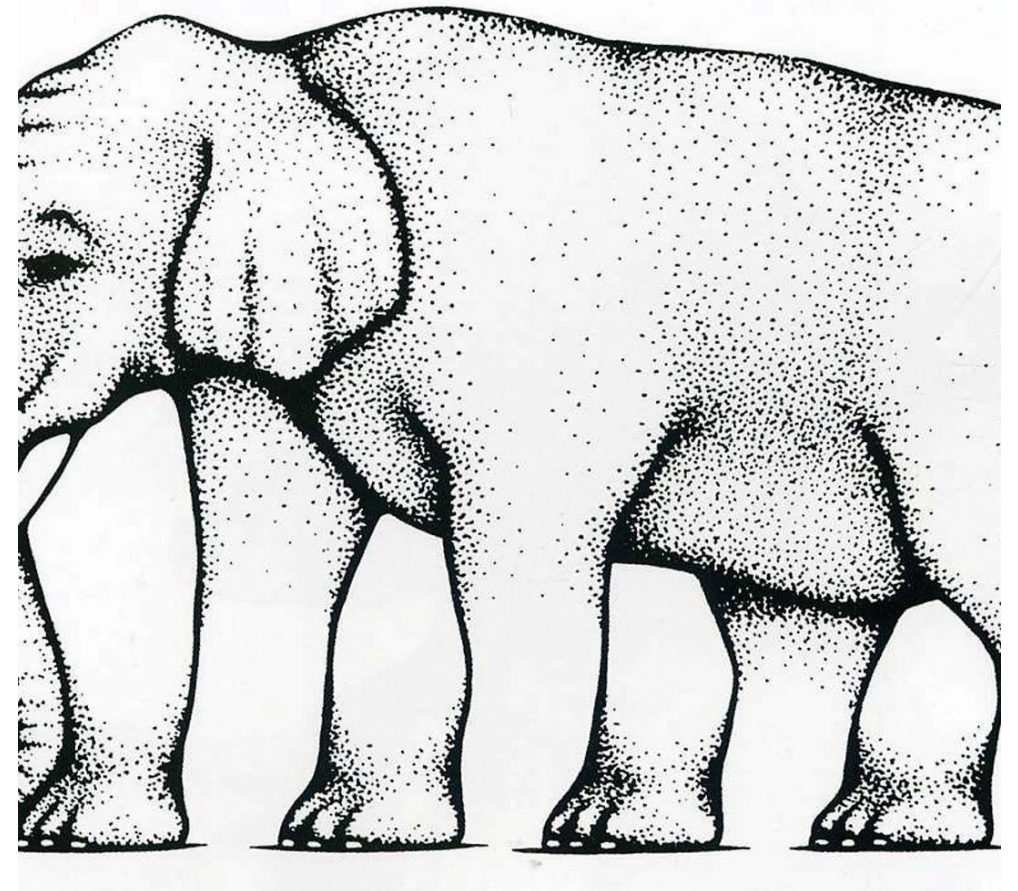
Thus, all indicators point to Hari's poor performance being caused by an external factor, such as difficult task or a demanding customers.

Based on attribution, Karan may explore ways in which to minimise the negative effects of the external factors on Hari's performance rather than attempting to influence his level of effort.

Errors and Biases in Attributions

Fundamental Attribution Error

The tendency to underestimate the influence of external factors and overestimate the influence of internal factors when making judgments about the behavior of others.



E.g.

Susan has an interview with Gomendra at 12 pm. She catches the train and when she is getting off, she gets pushed by another passenger who is running for another train. In the process, Susan twists and sprains her ankle. Filled with pain she hopes to get to the interview on time.

When she arrives, she is over 30 minutes late. Laxman and Lila who are the interviewees say to each other, 'she's late and not very punctual. I don't know if we can trust her to come to work every day on time'. 'It must be something in her character'.

Despite having a good interview, Susan doesn't get the job. Laxman and Lila blame the poor punctuality on her character. In other words, they think it's a distributional attribution. Perhaps she is just a disorganised person, but that wouldn't fit well into the role.

Yet, the real reason was a situational attribution. She sprained her ankle. A situation she could not have foreseen. In turn, there is a fundamental attribution error.

HOW WE JUDGE OTHERS



tribute a person's behaviour to their character without taking into account the situational factors and constraints within which the person might be operating.

HOW WE JUDGE OTHERS

Anna is unreliable.
She can't even attend
a meeting on time



Ben is incompetent.
He can't finish his
projects on time

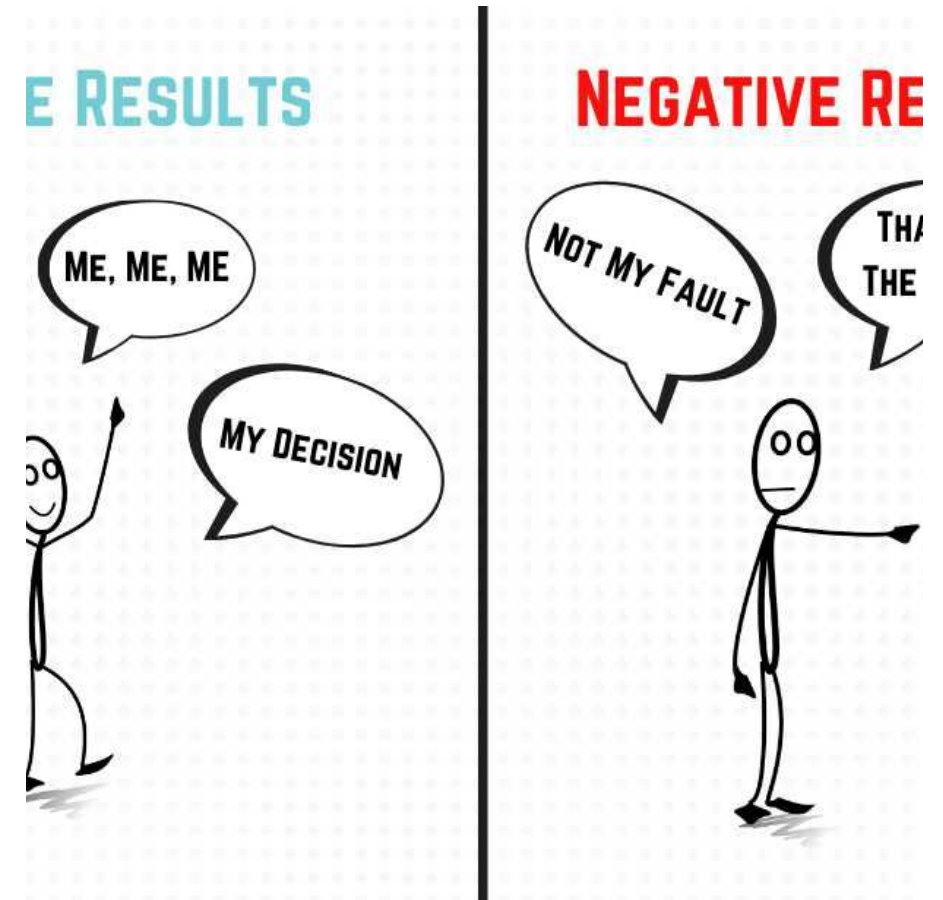
We attribute a person's behaviour to their character without taking into account the limitations and constraints within which the person might be operating

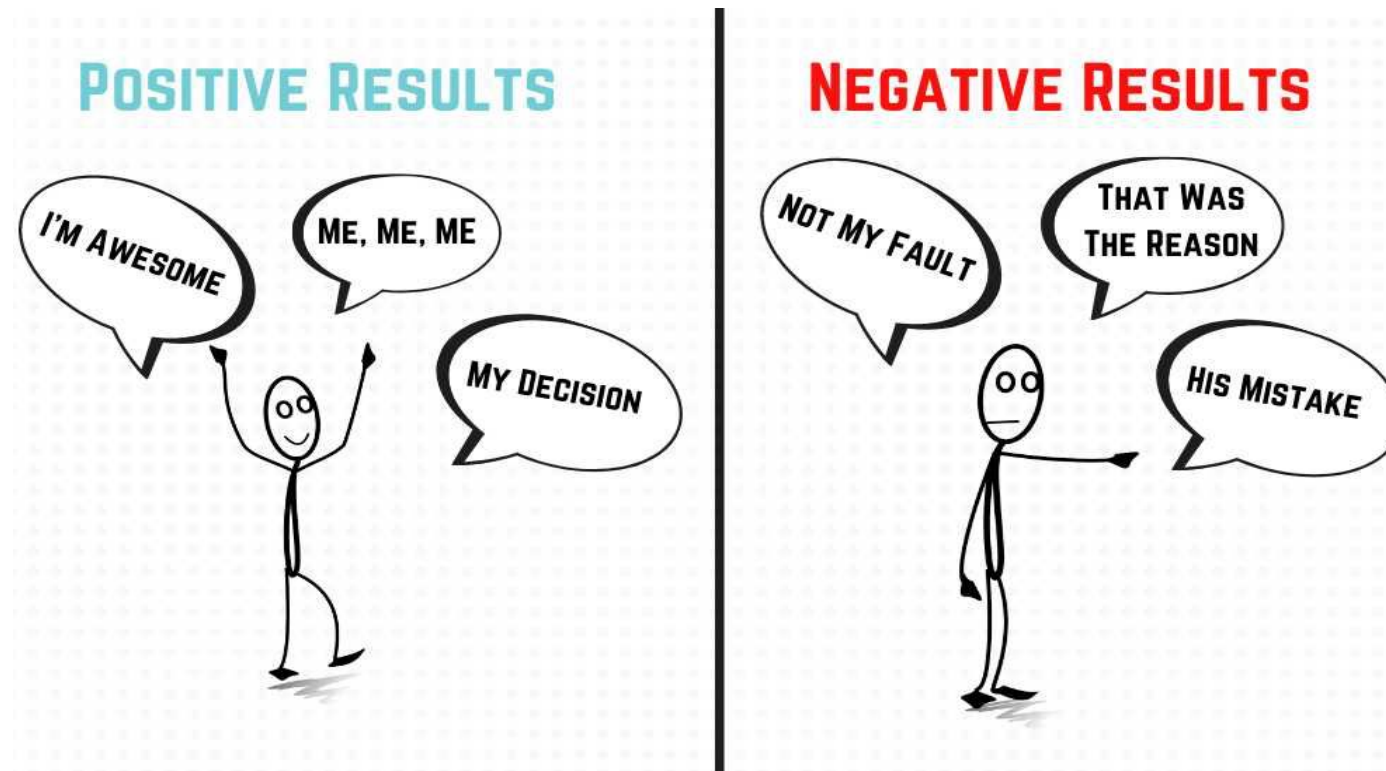
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Self-serving bias

This is a tendency for individual to attribute their own success to internal factors while putting blame for failures on external factors.





Perception and Decision Making

Individual decision making is influenced by perception. How individuals make decisions and the quality of their final choice are influenced by perception.

The following steps involved in decision making are influenced by perception.

- Gathering information
- Developing alternatives
- Making a choice

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Personality

Personality is a key factor that influences individual behavior in organization. Personality of individual relates psychological growth and development of the individual and it differs from person to person.

□ Stephen P. Robbins:

Personality is the sum total of ways in which an individual reacts and interacts with others.

□ Arnold and Feldman

Personality is a stable set of personal characteristics and tendencies that determine the commonalities and differences in people's thoughts, feelings and actions.



Personality Traits or Characteristics

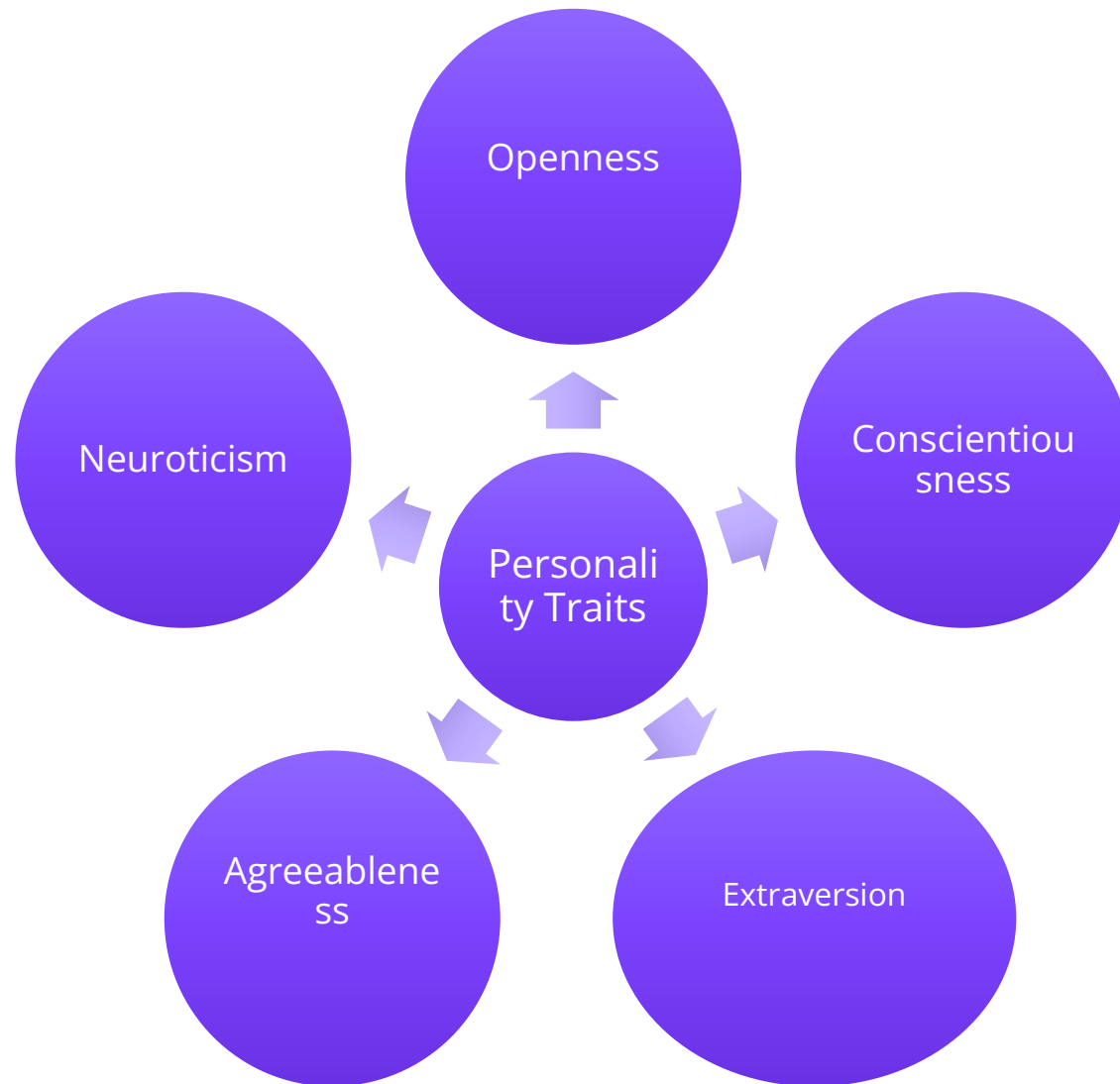
Personality traits are enduring characteristics that describe an individual's behavior.

The Big Five Dimensions of Personality.

Personality traits are many. However, research on personality traits indicates that The Big Five Dimensions encompass most of the variations in Personality.

- Openness
- Conscientiousness
- Extraversion
- Agreeableness
- Neuroticism





Openness measures the extent to which an individual is imaginative and creative, as opposed to down-to-earth and conventional.

It describes a person's tendency to think in abstract, complex ways. High scorers tend to be creative, adventurous, and intellectual. They enjoy playing with ideas and discovering novel experiences. Low scorers tend to be practical, conventional, and focused on the concrete. They tend to avoid the unknown and follow traditional ways.

Conscientiousness is a measure of how careful, deliberate, self-disciplined, and organized an individual is. Conscientiousness is often predictive of employee productivity, particularly in lower-level positions.

It describes a person's ability to exercise self-discipline and control in order to pursue their goals. High scorers are organized and determined, and are able to forego immediate gratification for the sake of long-term achievement. Low scorers are impulsive and easily sidetracked.



Extraversion is a measure of how sociable, outgoing, and energetic an individual is. Individuals who score lower on the extraversion scale are considered to be more introverted, or more deliberate, quiet, low key, and independent. Some types of positions are better suited for individuals who fall on one side of the spectrum or the other.

It describes a person's inclination to seek stimulation from the outside world, especially in the form of attention from other people. Extraverts engage actively with others to earn friendship, admiration, power, status, excitement, and romance. Introverts, on the other hand, conserve their energy, and do not work as hard to earn these social rewards.



Agreeableness is a measure of an individual's tendencies with respect to social harmony. This trait reflects how well the individual gets along with others, how cooperative or skeptical they are, and how they might interact within a team.

It describes a person's tendency to put others' needs ahead of their own, and to cooperate rather than compete with others. People who are high in Agreeableness experience a great deal of empathy and tend to get pleasure out of serving and taking care of others. They are usually trusting and forgiving. People who are low in Agreeableness tend to experience less empathy and put their own concerns ahead of others.



Neuroticism measures the ways in which individuals react to stress.

It describes a person's tendency to experience negative emotions, including fear, sadness, anxiety, guilt, and shame. While everyone experiences these emotions from time to time, some people are more prone to them than others. High Neuroticism scorers are more likely to react to a situation with fear, anger, sadness, and the like. Low Neuroticism scorers are more likely to brush off their misfortune and move on.



<https://www.truity.com/test/big-five-personality-test>



HEXACO Model

(Ashton & Lee, 2007)



HONESTY-HUMILITY (H)	EXTRAVERSION (X)	CONSCIENTIOUSNESS (O)
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Sincerity	Social Self-esteem	Organization
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Fairness	Social boldness	Diligence
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Greed Avoidance	Sociability	Perfectionism
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Modesty	Liveliness	Prudence
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EMOTIONALITY (E)	AGREEABLENESS (A)	OPENNESS (C)
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Fearfulness	Forgiveness	Aesthetic Appreciation
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Anxiety	Gentleness	Inquisitiveness
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Dependence	Patience	Creativity
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Sentimentality		Unconventionality
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<http://hexaco.org/hexaco-online>

Major Personality Attributes Influencing Organizational Behavior

PERCEPTION AND PERSONALITY

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Machiavellianism: Named after the famous political philosopher, Niccolo Machiavelli, this trait refers to individuals who manipulate the behavior of others, often through duplicity. Machiavellians are often interested in money and power, and pragmatically use others in this quest.

Need for Achievement: Those high in need for achievement want to accomplish a lot and set high standards of excellence for themselves. They are able to work persistently and hard for distant goals. David McClelland argued that economic growth depends in part on citizens with high need for achievement.

Need for Cognition: People high in need for cognition find it rewarding to understand things, and are willing to use considerable cognitive effort in this quest. Such individuals enjoy learning, and the process of trying to understand new things.



Authoritarianism: Authoritarians believe in strict social hierarchies, in which they are totally obedient to those above them, and expect complete obedience from their subordinates. Rigid in adherence to rules, the authoritarian personality is very uncomfortable with uncertainty.

Narcissism: The narcissistic personality has self-love that is so strong that it results in high levels of vanity, conceit, and selfishness. The narcissistic individual often has problems feeling empathetic toward others and grateful to others.

Self-esteem: The tendency to evaluate oneself positively. Self-esteem does not imply that one believes that he or she is better than others, only that he or she is a person of worth.



Optimism: The tendency to expect positive outcomes in the future. People who are optimistic expect good things to happen, and indeed they often have more positive outcomes, perhaps because they work harder to achieve them.

Alexithymia: The inability to recognize and label emotions in oneself. The individual also has a difficult time recognizing emotions in others, and often has difficulties in relationships.

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THANK YOU

QUESTIONS